QUALITY COUNCIL® OF INDIA
Creating an Ecosystem for Quality

DRDO

System for Advanced Maturity Assessment and Rating
सिस्टम फॉर एडवांस्ड मैच्योरिटी असेसमेंट एंड रेटिंग
SAMAR
Strengthening Defence Ecosystem

Applicant Handbook

Introduction

This handbook is the official guide for applicant organisations using SAMAR, the System for Advanced Maturity Assessment and Rating. SAMAR is administered jointly by the Quality Council of India (QCI) and the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO), Ministry of Defence.

It explains, step by step, how an enterprise registers, submits an application, remits the fee and obtains a certificate through the SAMAR web portal. Two accounts are held on the applicant side. The Enterprise Admin is the principal account of the organisation. The Unit Admin is the officer-in-charge of a single factory or site.

Account held	Parts to be referred
Principal account of the organisation	Part 1 and Part 2: Enterprise Admin
Officer-in-charge of a single unit or site	Part 1 and Part 3: Unit Admin

> Each unit is certified separately. A separate application is accordingly to be made in respect of every site for which certification is sought.

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Part 1: General Information

Applicable to both applicant accounts

1.1 About SAMAR

System for Advanced Maturity Assessment and Rating (SAMAR) is a benchmark to measure the maturity of defence manufacturing and service enterprises. Developed by the Quality Council of India (QCI), the certification is applicable to start-up, micro, small, medium, and large enterprises.

SAMAR is an outcome of the collaboration between Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and Quality Council of India (QCI) to strengthen the defence ecosystem in the country with an objective to further the vision of making India self-reliant in defence manufacturing and services.

SAMAR is accessed through a web portal on a desktop or laptop computer. No mobile application is required of an applicant, except for a unit applying under the service sector (paragraph 2.7).

1.2 Who does what

The applicant deals with the following offices in the course of an application.

Office	Responsibility
Enterprise Admin	The organisation's principal account: registers, applies, remits the fee, downloads certificates.
Unit Admin	The officer-in-charge of one unit: applies for that unit and supports the assessment.
DRDO Admin	Approves or rejects an application.
QCI Operations team	Allots the assessors, confirms the assessment date and reviews the submitted assessment.
Assessor	Conducts the on-site assessment. Allotted by QCI; not chosen by the applicant.
Rating committee	Determines the rating, upon which the certificate is issued.

1.3 Logging in

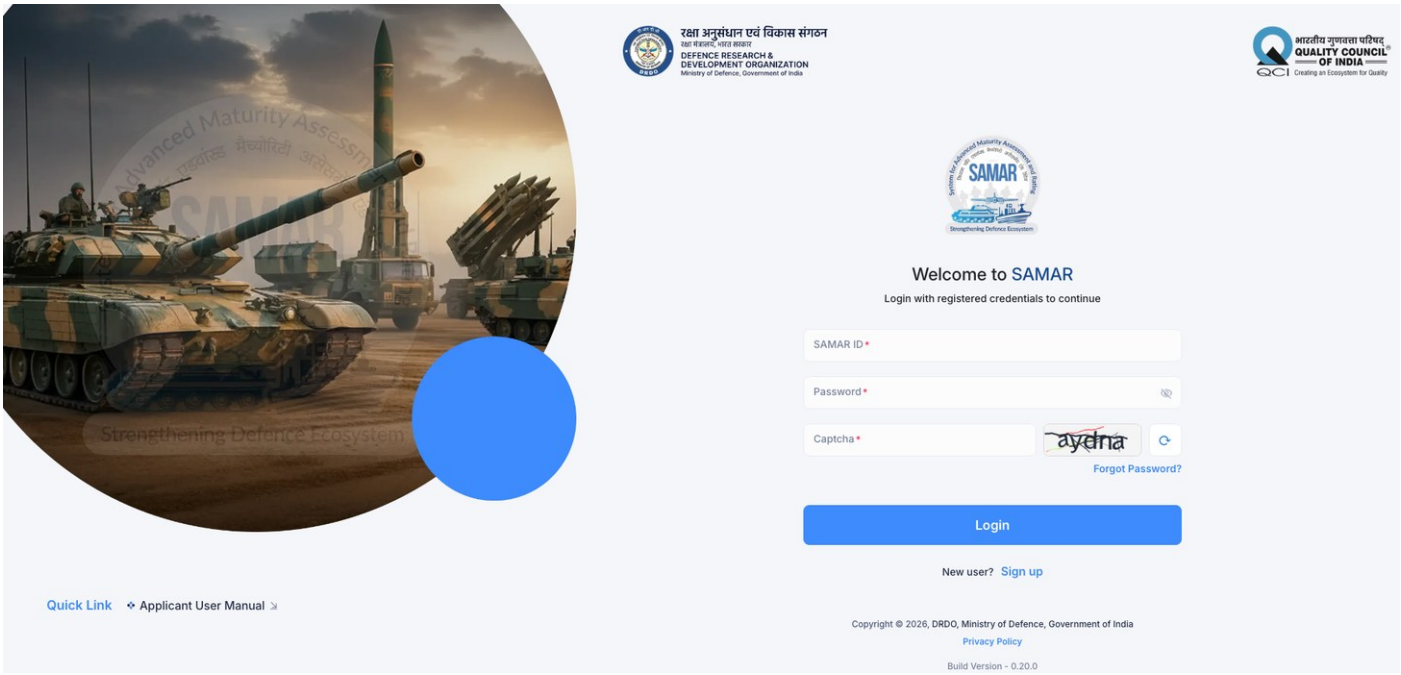
1. Open the SAMAR portal in a web browser.
2. Enter the SAMAR ID together with the password.

   Validation: Both fields are mandatory. The SAMAR ID is the login identifier issued to the user, in the form SAMAR-DDMMYY-N (for example SAMAR-080125-123). Passwords are 7 to 20 characters and case-sensitive.
3. Enter the characters shown in the captcha image. Select the refresh icon beside it for a new image.

   Validation: The captcha is not case-sensitive and is valid for five minutes. After an unsuccessful attempt a new image is shown and is to be entered afresh.
4. Select Login.
5. If two-factor authentication is enabled for the account, enter the six-digit one-time password (OTP) sent to the registered email address and select Verify.

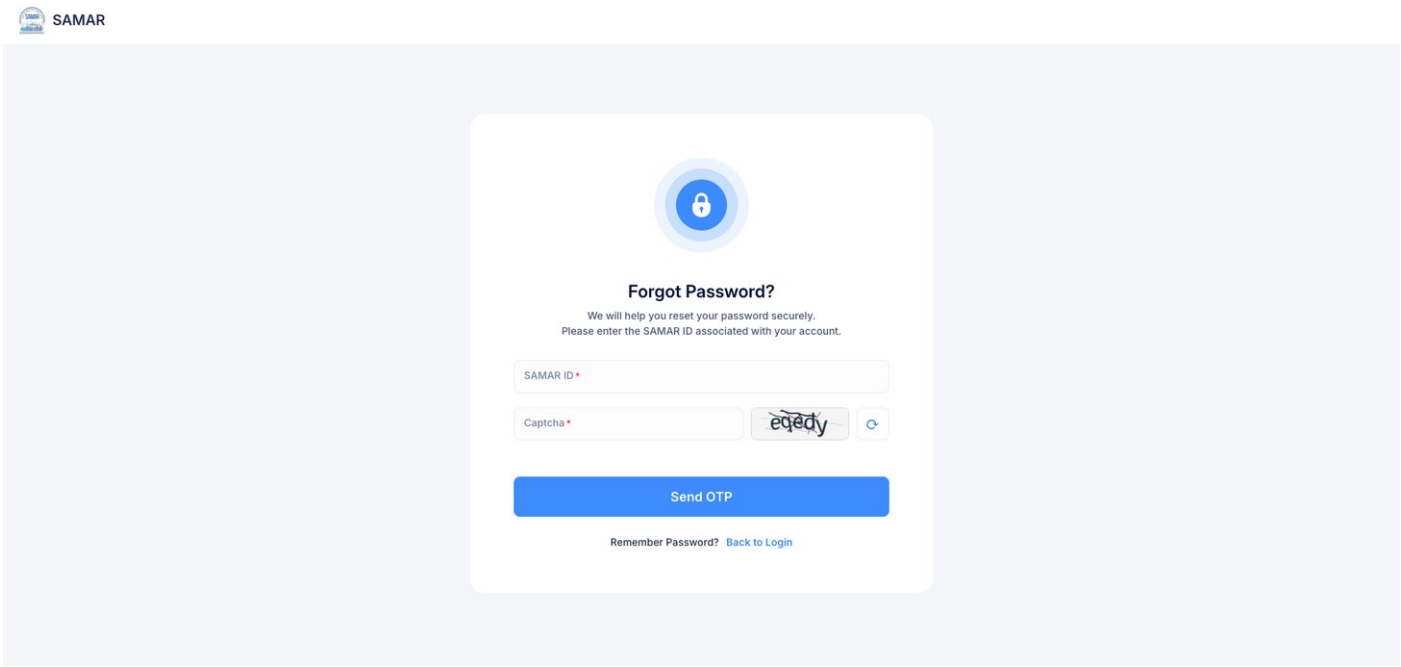
   Validation: The OTP is valid for a limited period. Select Resend if it has lapsed.

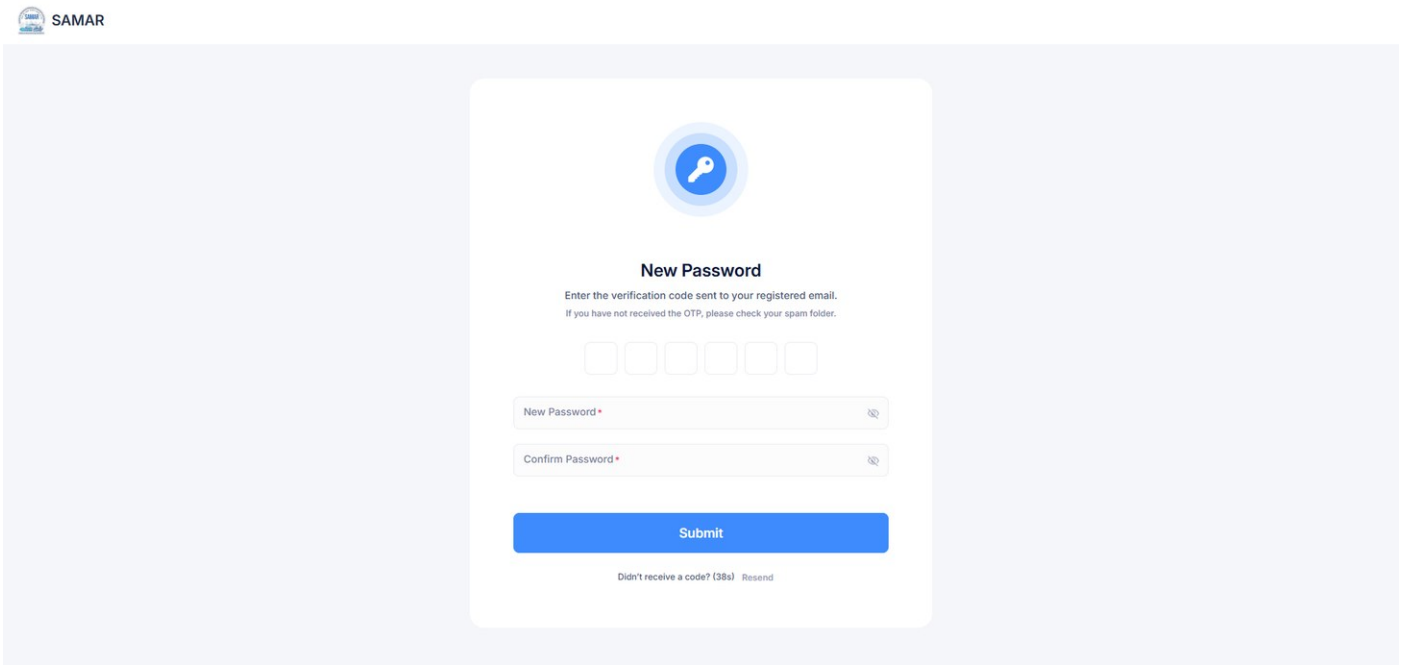
Each account is restricted to one active web session. Logging in again terminates the previous session. If a user is notified of a login that was not initiated by them, the password is to be changed immediately.



1.4 Password reset

1. On the login screen, select Forgot Password.
2. Enter the SAMAR ID and the captcha characters, and select Send OTP. A six-digit OTP is sent to the registered email address. It may be resent after 120 seconds.
3. Enter the OTP, then enter and confirm a new password of 7 to 20 characters, and log in again.

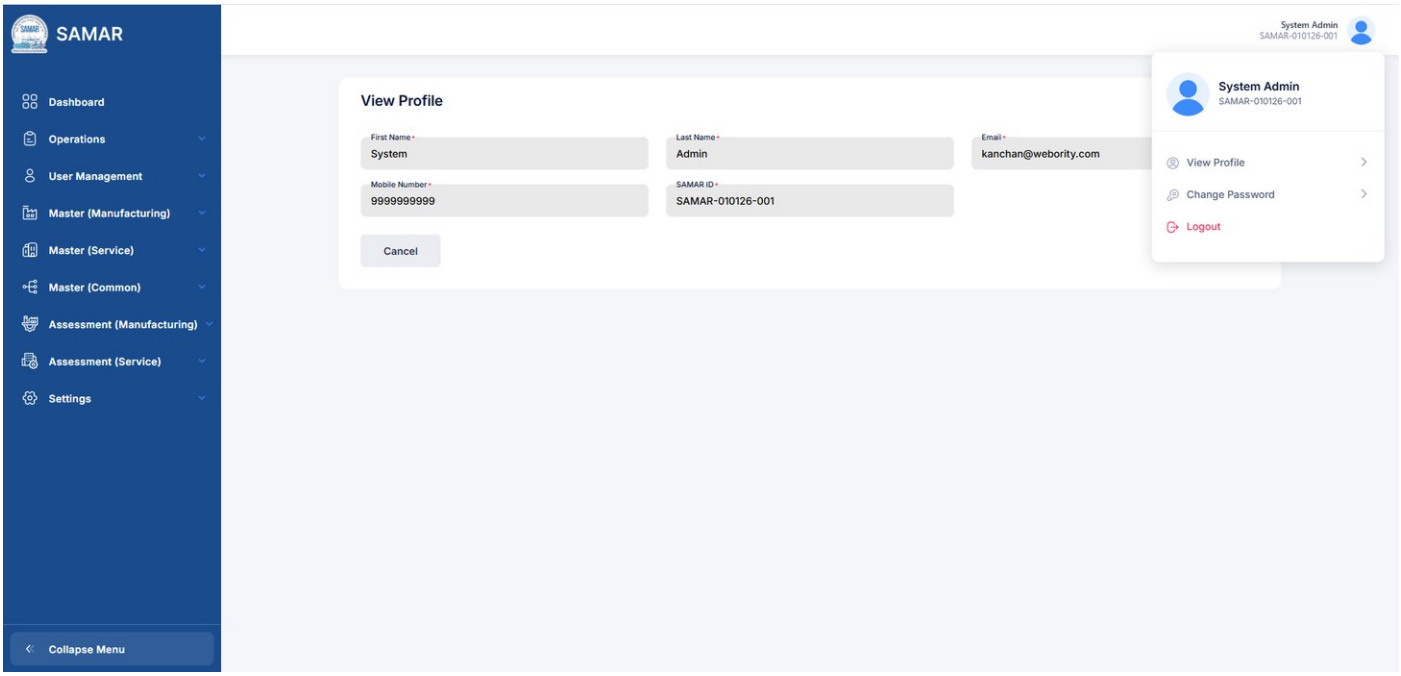




1.5 The profile menu

Select the user name displayed at the top-right of any screen. The following options are available:

- View Profile: displays the user's registered particulars.
- Change Password: permits a new password to be set while logged in.
- Logout: terminates the session. Confirmation is sought before the session is closed.



1.6 Assistance and support

Both applicant accounts are provided a Support option in the left menu through which a request may be raised and its progress monitored. This is the ordinary means by which assistance is to be sought. The SAMAR ID and the application number are to be quoted in every request, as this enables the earliest resolution.

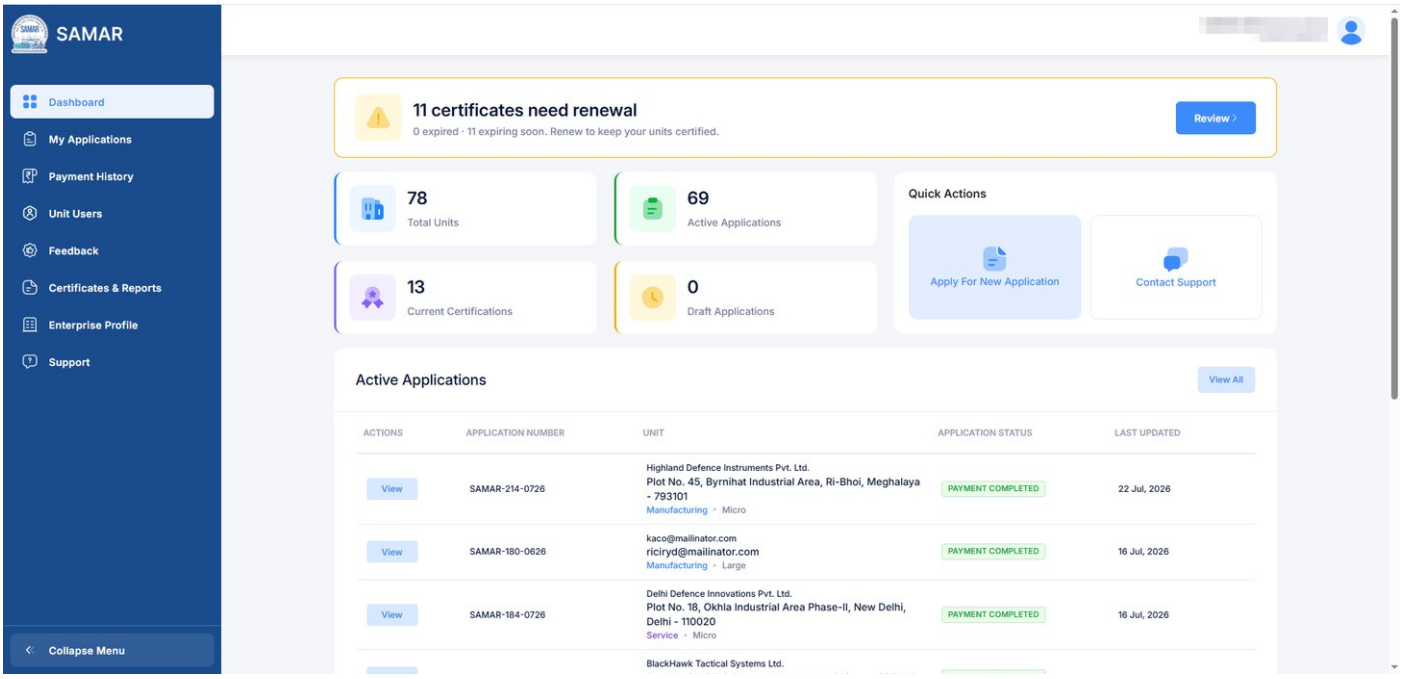
> Should a maintenance notice be displayed, the system is temporarily unavailable on account of planned maintenance. Users are requested to attempt access subsequently. No saved data is lost during maintenance.

Part 2: Enterprise Admin

Principal account of the applicant organisation

2.1 Menu structure

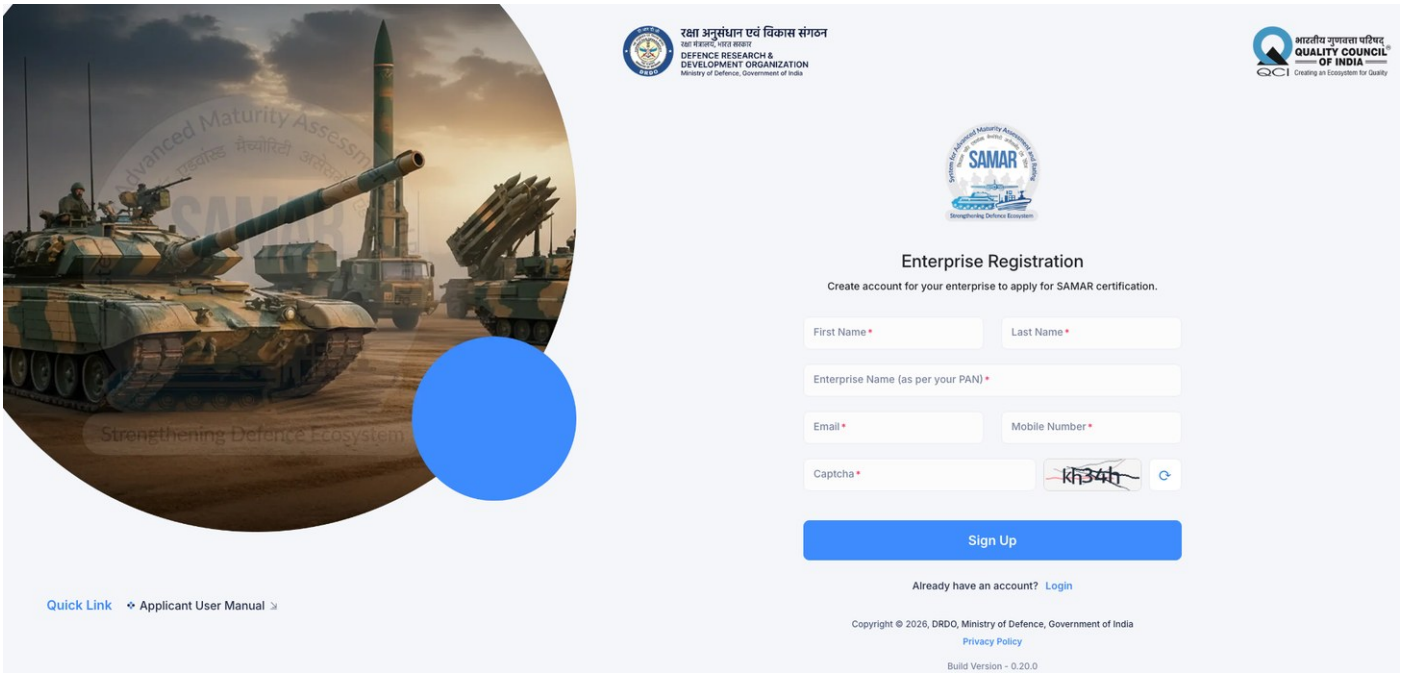
Menu	Purpose
Dashboard	Summary counts of units, active applications, drafts and certificates.
My Applications	Create a new application, resume a draft, monitor progress and view details.
Payment History	All fee payments and receipts of the organisation.
Unit Users	Read-only list of the Unit Admin accounts of the enterprise, with each account's unit and last login.
Feedback	Submit the post-assessment feedback.
Certificates & Reports	Download certificates and assessment reports of all units.
Enterprise Profile	View and amend the particulars of the organisation.
Support	Raise a support request and monitor its status.



2.2 Registration and first login

1. Open the SAMAR portal and select Sign up.
2. Enter the enterprise name as per the organisation's PAN, the name of the contact person, the email address and the ten-digit mobile number, followed by the captcha characters, and select Sign Up.

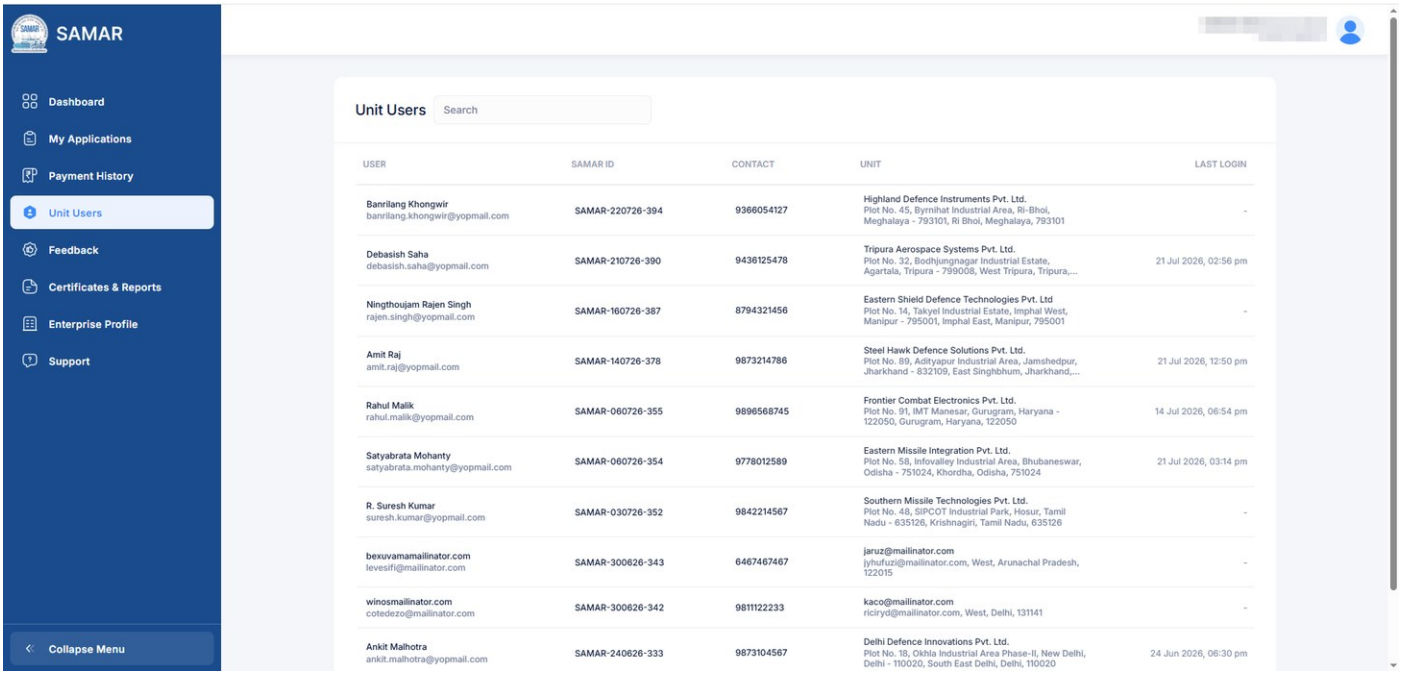
   Validation: All one-time passwords, approvals and notices are sent to the email address entered here. It is to be kept current and accessible.
3. Enter the OTP received at that email address in order to verify it.
4. Set a password and complete the registration. The account so created is the Enterprise Admin account.



2.3 Units and unit users

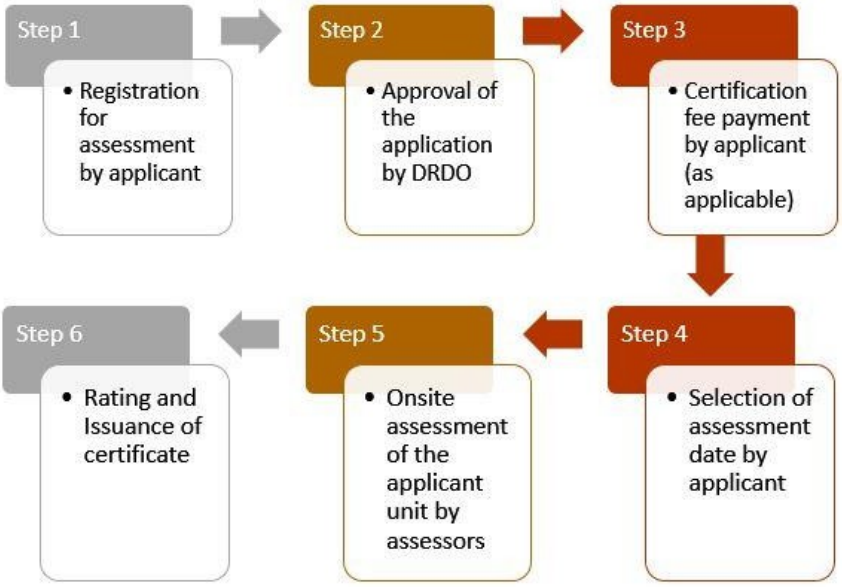
A unit denotes a single factory or site, and each unit is certified separately. Units are not added from a separate screen: a unit is created automatically when an application is first created for it (paragraph 2.4), from the unit particulars entered in that application.

The Unit Admin account for the unit is likewise created automatically, from the contact person entered in that first application, and the login credentials are sent to the contact person's email address. Unit Users lists these accounts; they are not created or edited there. In the event of a change of incumbent, the unit may be reassigned to a different Unit Admin, and fresh credentials are emailed to the new incumbent.



2.4 Creating an application

The certification process comprises the following six stages:

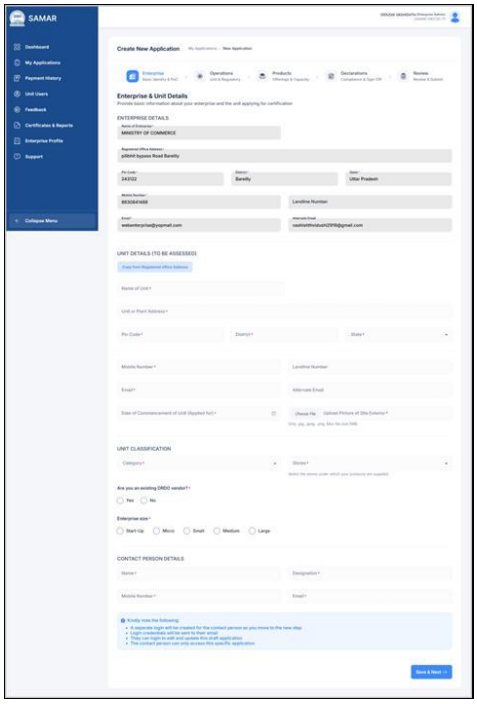


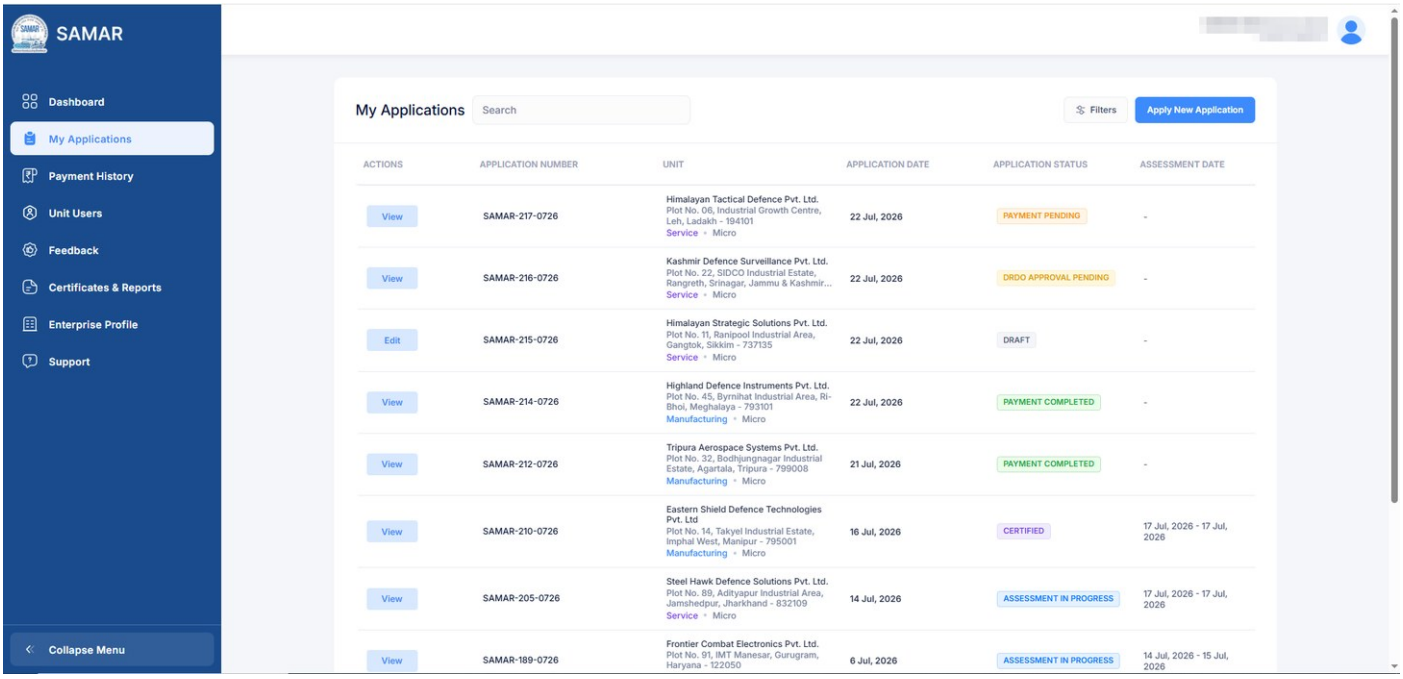
The following documents are uploaded within the application and are to be kept ready. Files are PDF, JPG, JPEG or PNG, up to 5 MB each.

Document	When it is required
Site exterior photograph	Always. JPG, JPEG or PNG only.
GST certificate	If the enterprise is GST-registered.
Government registration certificate	If the enterprise is government-registered.
DRDO certificate	If the enterprise is an existing DRDO vendor.
DPIIT, Udyam or Incorporation certificate	Exactly one, according to the classification selected: DPIIT for a Startup, Udyam for a Micro, Small or Medium enterprise, Certificate of Incorporation for a Large enterprise.

1. Open My Applications and initiate a new application for either the manufacturing or the service sector.
2. Complete the five guided steps: Enterprise details, Operations, Products (or Services), Declarations and Review. The application may be saved and resumed at any step and remains in Draft status until submitted.
3. Submit the application. The status changes to Approval Pending while it is under review by DRDO.

Validation: An application once submitted cannot be edited. The unit and the contact person are to be verified prior to submission. Product, service, customer and process names must each be unique; export and import percentages cannot together exceed 100 per cent; a manufacturing unit lists at least one key raw material or bought-out part; both declarations on the final step are to be agreed.


SAMAR
Create New Application
Enterprise & Unit Details
ENTERPRISE DETAILS
UNIT DETAILS (TO BE ASSESSED)
UNIT CLASSIFICATION
CONTACT PERSON DETAILS


SAMAR
Dashboard
My Applications
Payment History
Unit Users
Feedback
Certificates & Reports
Enterprise Profile
Support
Collapse Menu
My Applications
Search
Filters
Apply New Application
ACTIONS
APPLICATION NUMBER
UNIT
APPLICATION DATE
APPLICATION STATUS
ASSESSMENT DATE
View
SAMAR-217-0726
Himalayan Tactical Defence Pvt. Ltd.
Plot No. 06, Industrial Growth Centre, Leh, Ladakh - 194101
Service • Micro
22 Jul, 2026
PAYMENT PENDING
View
SAMAR-216-0726
Kashmir Defence Surveillance Pvt. Ltd.
Plot No. 22, SIDCO Industrial Estate, Rangreth, Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir...
Service • Micro
22 Jul, 2026
DRDO APPROVAL PENDING
Edit
SAMAR-215-0726
Himalayan Strategic Solutions Pvt. Ltd.
Plot No. 11, Ranipool Industrial Area, Gangtok, Sikkim - 737135
Service • Micro
22 Jul, 2026
DRAFT
View
SAMAR-214-0726
Highland Defence Instruments Pvt. Ltd.
Plot No. 45, Byrnihat Industrial Area, Ri-Bhoi, Meghalaya - 793101
Manufacturing • Micro
22 Jul, 2026
PAYMENT COMPLETED
View
SAMAR-212-0726
Tripura Aerospace Systems Pvt. Ltd.
Plot No. 32, Bodhjungnagar Industrial Estate, Agartala, Tripura - 799008
Manufacturing • Micro
21 Jul, 2026
PAYMENT COMPLETED
View
SAMAR-210-0726
Eastern Shield Defence Technologies Pvt. Ltd
Plot No. 14, Takyel Industrial Estate, Imphal West, Manipur - 795001
Manufacturing • Micro
16 Jul, 2026
CERTIFIED
17 Jul, 2026 - 17 Jul, 2026
View
SAMAR-205-0726
Steel Hawk Defence Solutions Pvt. Ltd.
Plot No. 89, Adityapur Industrial Area, Jamshedpur, Jharkhand - 832109
Service • Micro
14 Jul, 2026
ASSESSMENT IN PROGRESS
17 Jul, 2026 - 17 Jul, 2026
View
SAMAR-189-0726
Frontier Combat Electronics Pvt. Ltd.
Plot No. 91, IMT Manesar, Gurugram, Haryana - 122050
6 Jul, 2026
ASSESSMENT IN PROGRESS
14 Jul, 2026 - 15 Jul, 2026

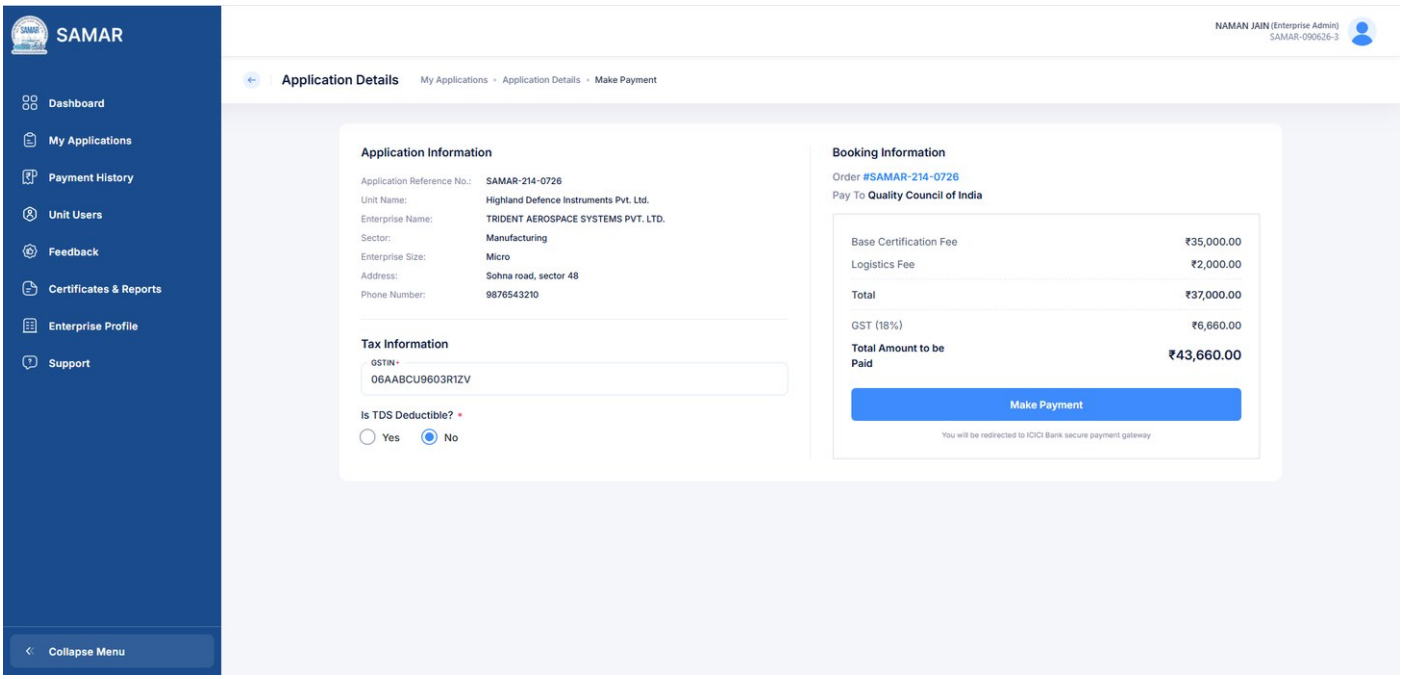
2.5 Remitting the fee

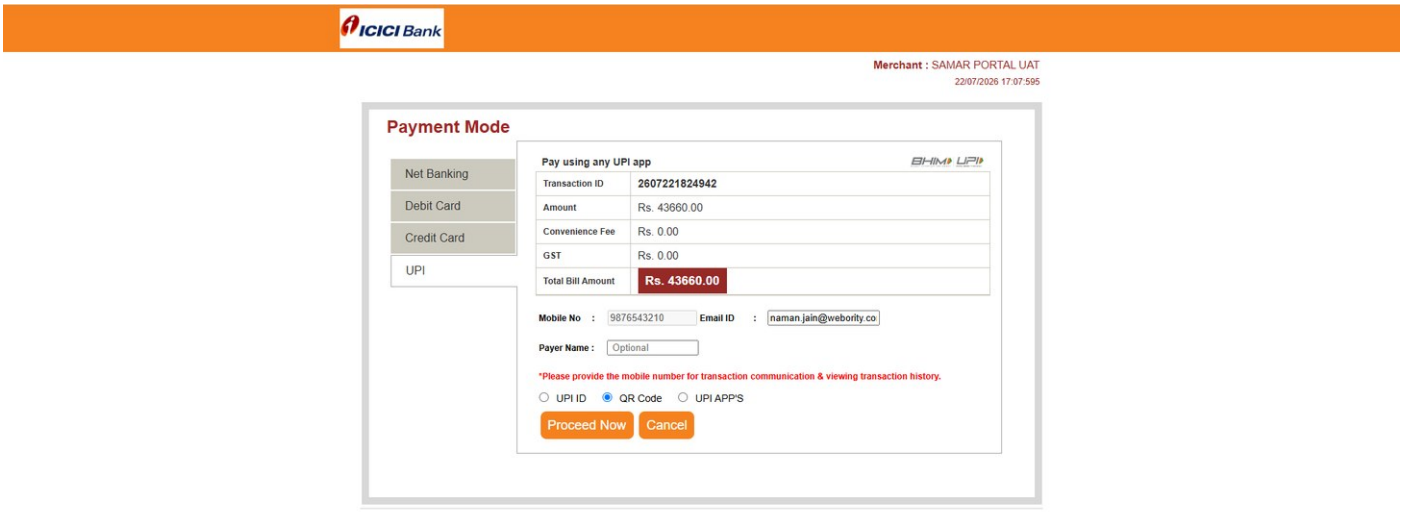
Upon approval of the application by DRDO, the fee is to be remitted online through ICICI EazyPay. The fee is determined by the size of the enterprise. Goods and Services Tax at 18 per cent is included in the amounts below.

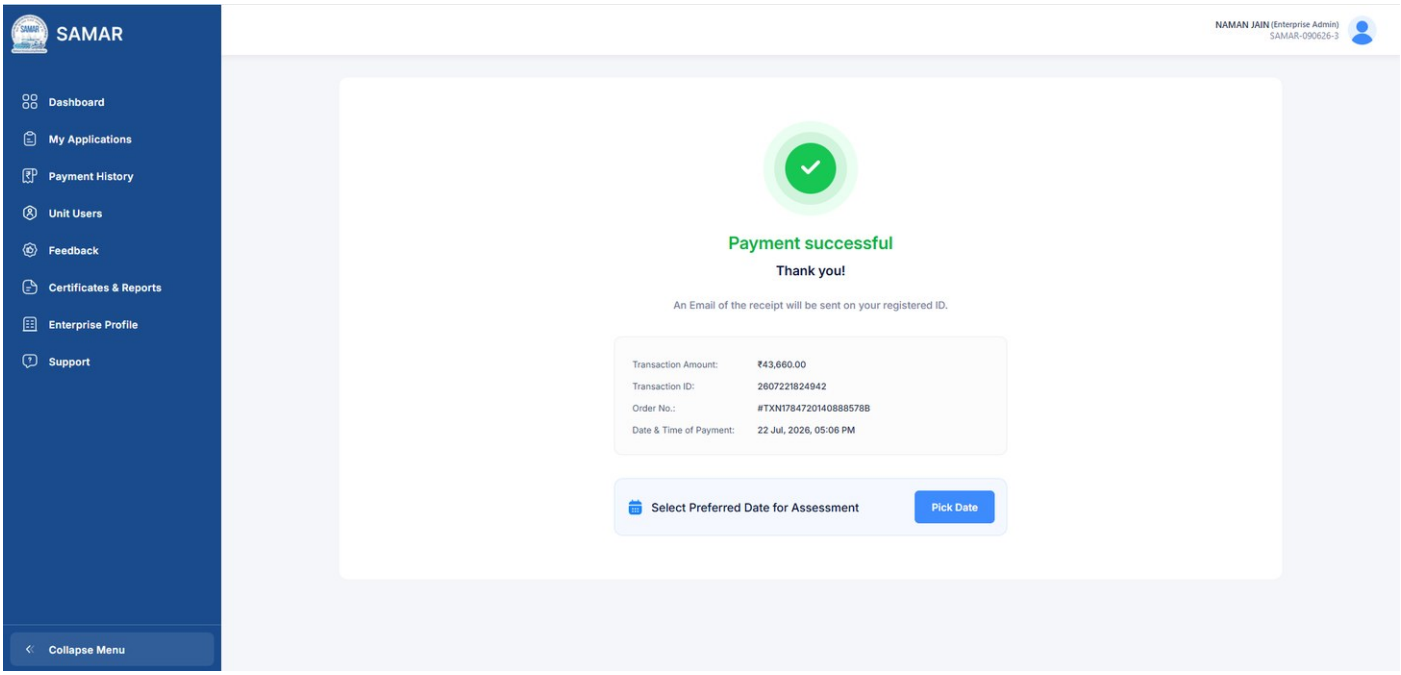
Size of enterprise	Total fee (inclusive of 18% GST)
Startup	₹37,760
Micro	₹43,660
Small	₹49,560
Medium	₹55,460
Large	₹61,360

1. Open the application, select the payment option and verify the amount displayed.
2. Proceed to the secure banking page and remit the amount by card, net banking or UPI.
3. Await redirection to the SAMAR portal. The payment is confirmed automatically and a receipt is recorded under Payment History.

Important: The browser must not be closed and the back button must not be used while the transaction is in progress. If an amount is debited but the status is not updated, a second payment must not be made. The matter is to be reported to the SAMAR Operations team along with the application number.

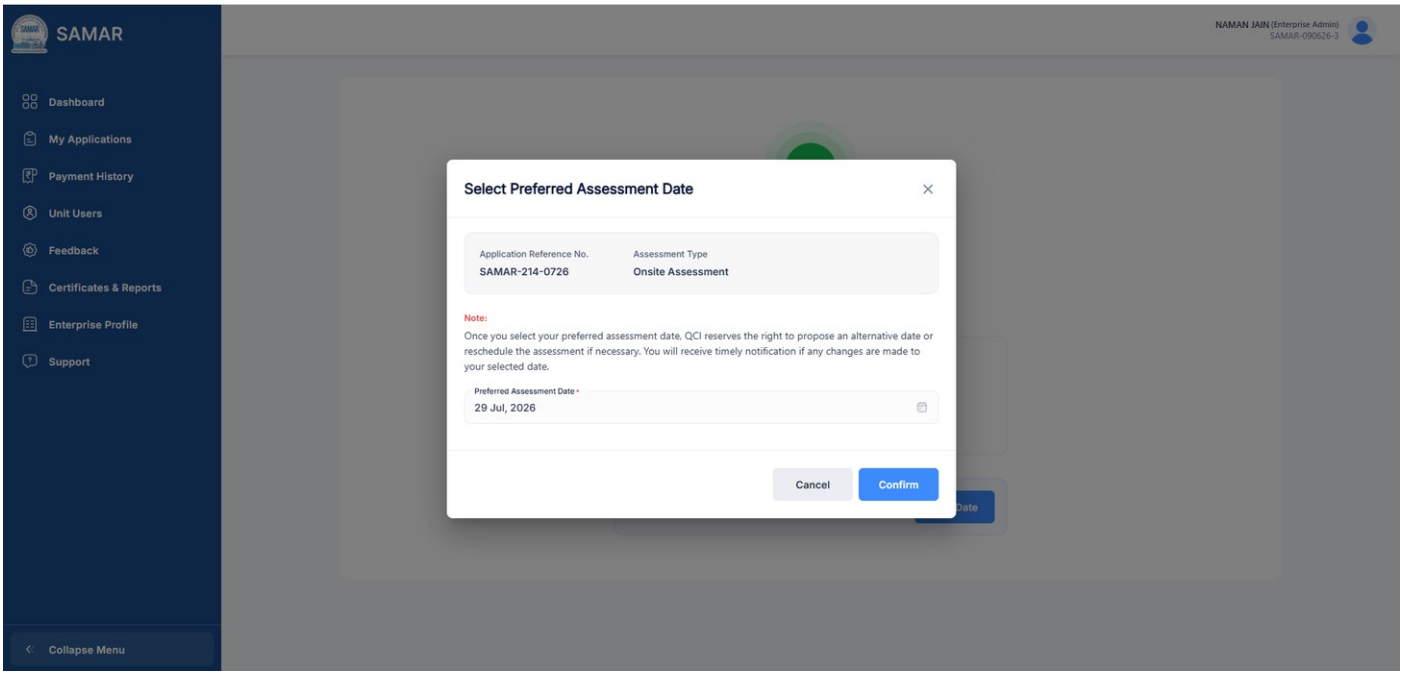






2.6 Preferred assessment date

Following remittance of the fee, a preferred date for the assessment may be indicated and the contact person for the visit confirmed. The QCI Operations team thereafter allots the assessors and confirms the final date. A preference indicated by the applicant does not constitute a confirmed booking.



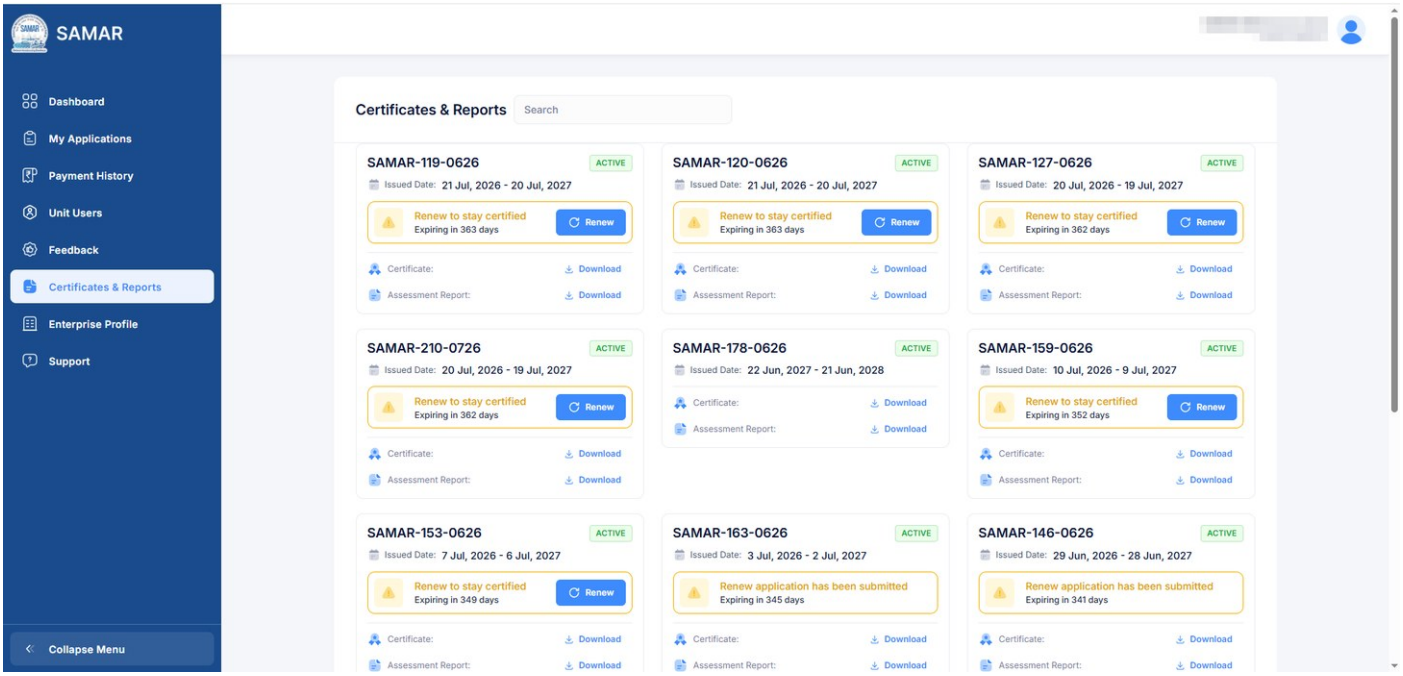
2.7 During the assessment

The assessment is conducted by the assessor allotted by QCI. The applicant is to keep the officer-in-charge available at the site on the confirmed date, upload the site photographs and site-tour photographs called for in respect of the unit, and furnish, through the SAMAR Operations team, any clarification sought by the assessor or the rating committee. The assessment summary may be viewed against the application.

Where the unit has applied under the service sector, the applicant is additionally required to install the SAMAR Applicant mobile application and, through it, to capture and upload the pictures called for as evidence. In the manufacturing sector the assessor records the photographs on site and no such application is required.

2.8 Certificates and reports

Upon certification of a unit by the rating committee, the certificate and the assessment report may be downloaded from Certificates & Reports. Records of every unit of the enterprise are available at this location.



2.9 Feedback

On completion of an assessment, the application is listed under Feedback. The brief questionnaire regarding the applicant's experience is to be completed.

2.10 Renewal

Within the renewal window before a certificate expires (90 days by default), the certified application may be renewed, and an intimation is sent by email. On initiation of renewal, the certified application is copied into a fresh, pre-filled draft. The particulars are to be verified, any changes incorporated, and the application submitted afresh.

> Renewal may be initiated only by the Enterprise Admin. The renewal application is processed through the same six stages, including remittance of a fresh fee and a fresh site assessment.

Part 3: Unit Admin

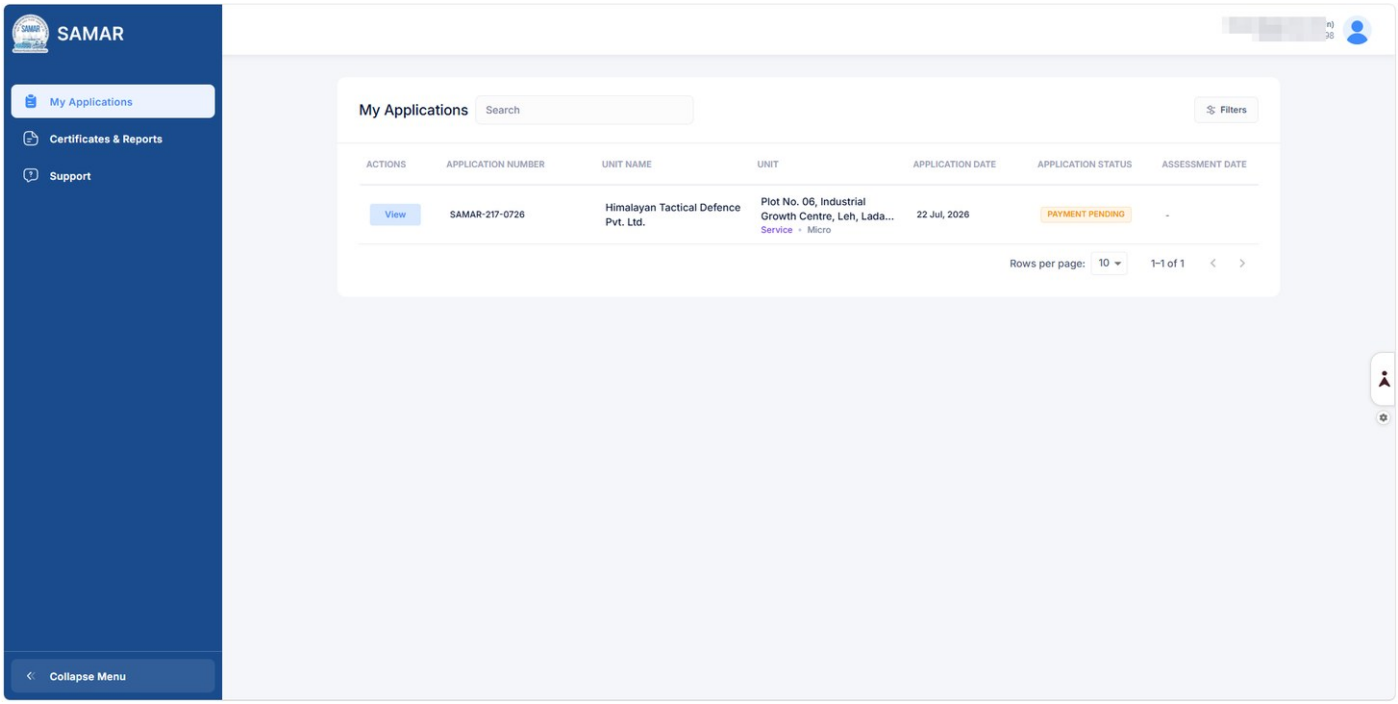
Officer-in-charge of a single unit or site

3.1 Menu structure

The Unit Admin account is created by the system from the contact person entered in the unit's first application, and the credentials are emailed to that person. It covers the assigned unit only.

Menu	Purpose
My Applications	Applications of the assigned unit: initiate a new application, resume a draft or view details.
Certificates & Reports	Download the certificate and assessment report of the assigned unit.
Support	Raise a support request and monitor its status.

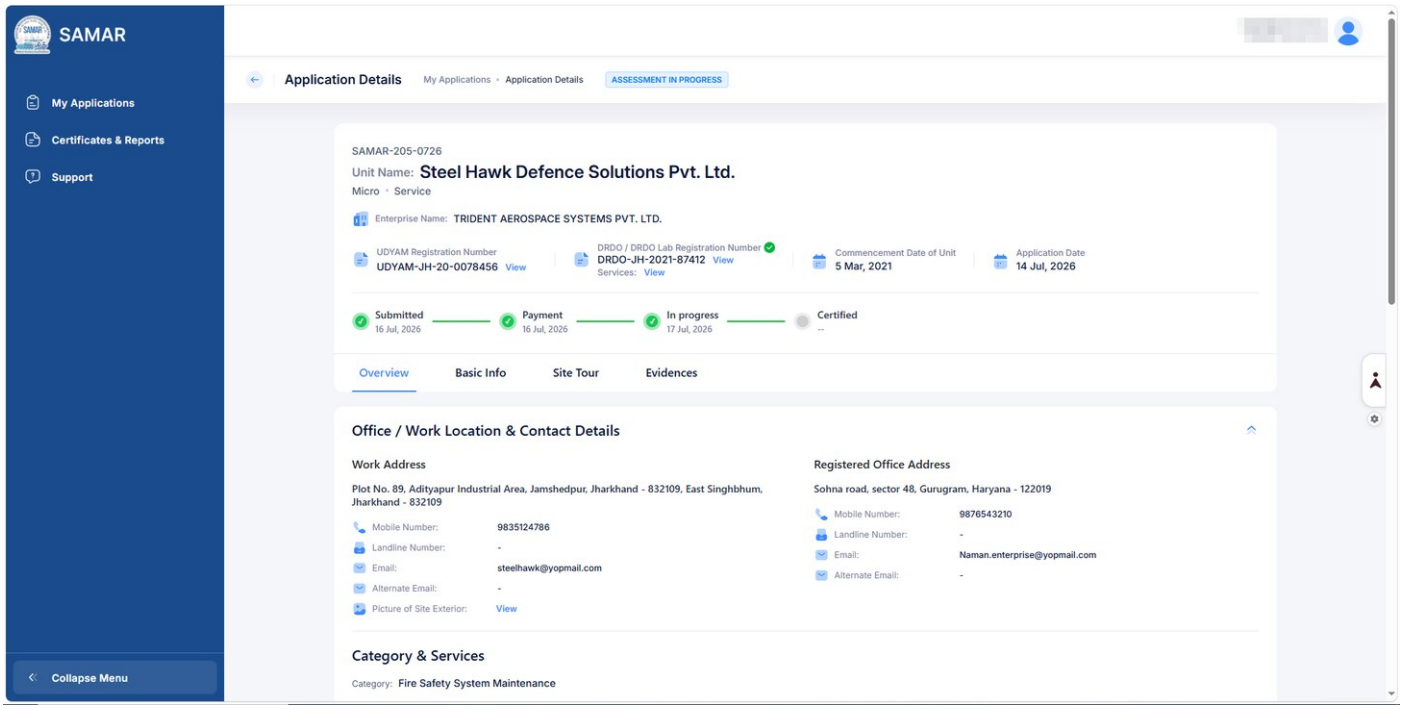
A dashboard is not provided to this role. On successful login, the My Applications screen is displayed.



3.2 My Applications

1. Select the option to create a new application and indicate whether it pertains to the manufacturing or the service sector.
2. Furnish the particulars called for, as set out in paragraph 2.4. The application may be saved as often as required and remains in Draft status until submitted.
3. Submit the application. The status changes to Approval Pending while it is under review by DRDO.

Any application may be opened to view its tabs, namely Basic Info, Evidences, Site Tour and Payment.



3.3 Fee, assessment and certificate

The assessment fee is remitted by the Enterprise Admin of the organisation, and not by the Unit Admin. Upon approval of the application by DRDO, the Unit Admin is to intimate the Enterprise Admin in order that the fee may be remitted (paragraph 2.5). The status of the application, including remittance of the fee, may be followed from My Applications.

During the assessment, the site photographs and site-tour photographs called for in respect of the unit are to be uploaded, and the officer-in-charge is to remain available to the assessor on the date of the visit. A unit applying under the service sector additionally uploads its evidence pictures through the SAMAR Applicant mobile application (paragraph 2.7).

Following certification, the certificate and the assessment report of the unit may be downloaded from Certificates & Reports. Renewal is initiated by the Enterprise Admin, and is to be requested from that account.

Appendix A: Application and assessment stages

Every application and assessment proceeds through the stages set out below. The nomenclature is uniform across all roles.

Stage displayed	Meaning	Action rests with
Draft	Under preparation; not yet submitted.	Enterprise / Unit Admin
Approval pending	Submitted and awaiting the decision of DRDO.	DRDO Admin
Payment pending	Approved and awaiting remittance of the fee.	Enterprise / Unit Admin
Payment completed	Fee received; the assessment record has been created.	Operations Manager
Allocation pending	Awaiting allotment of an assessor team and a date.	Operations Manager
Scheduled	Assessor team and date confirmed.	Assessor
In progress	The assessment is being conducted.	Assessor
Quality check	Submitted and under review by QCI.	Operations Manager
Quality check feedback	Returned to the assessor with observations.	Assessor
Ready for committee review	Cleared quality check; awaiting the rating committee.	Operations Admin
Committee review scheduled	Listed for a committee meeting.	Operations Admin
Committee review feedback	Clarification sought by the committee.	Assessor
Certified	Successfully concluded; the certificate has been issued.	-
Rejected	Not proceeded with. The reasons may be ascertained from the SAMAR Operations team.	-

Appendix B: Points of contact

Matter	To be referred to
Correction of an incorrect role, or a login that cannot be recovered	Support request, or the SAMAR Operations team
Status of an application awaiting approval	DRDO Admin, through the SAMAR Operations team
Change of an assessment date	Operations Manager, through a support request
Representation regarding a rating or a decision of the committee	Operations Admin, through the SAMAR Operations team
Report of a fault or an error message	Support request from the left menu
Amount debited but not recorded against the application	SAMAR Operations team, quoting the application number. A second payment must not be made.

A support request may be raised from the Support option in the left menu. The SAMAR ID and the application number are to be quoted in every request, as this enables the earliest resolution.